

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 1/12: Part XVII settlement: official language without a national language

ROOT QUESTION

How does one Union preserve common administration without linguistic uniformity?

PART XVII

Chapter I: Articles 343-344 | Union language.

Chapter II: Articles 345-347 | regional languages.

Chapter III: Articles 348-349 | courts and authoritative legal texts.

Chapter IV: Articles 350-351 | grievances, minorities and Hindi development.

CORE DISTINCTIONS

Union official language != national language.

scheduled != official everywhere | classical != scheduled | policy != Constitution.

SETTLEMENT

Hindi in Devanagari + international form of Indian numerals

paired with statutory continuation of English and federal safeguards.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 2/12: Articles 343-344 and the statutory continuation of English

ARTICLE 343

Hindi in Devanagari = official language of Union.

International form of Indian numerals = official numeral form.

English transition period did not create an automatic 1965 switch-off.

OFFICIAL LANGUAGES ACT 1963, AS AMENDED

section 3 continues English for Union official purposes and parliamentary business.

section 3(5) uses a high-consent legislative lock for specified discontinuance.

ARTICLE 344

President's Commission at five years and ten years from commencement.

30-member constitutional parliamentary committee: 20 Lok Sabha + 10 Rajya Sabha.

DO NOT COLLAPSE

Article 344 committee != section 4 statutory Committee on Official Language.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 3/12: 1963 Act: continuation and consent lock

SECTION 3

English continues in addition to Hindi for specified Union purposes and parliamentary business.

COMMUNICATION

Union to non-Hindi-official-language State -> English.

Hindi State to non-Hindi State in Hindi -> accompanying English translation.

ADMINISTRATIVE SAFEGUARDS

section 3(2) translation | 3(3) bilingual instruments

| 3(4) efficiency, public interest and employee non-disadvantage.

SECTION 3(5) LOCK

all specified State Legislatures + Lok Sabha + Rajya Sabha.

Executive preference, one State or one House cannot discontinue the protected use.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 4/12: Articles 345-347: State choice and intergovernmental communication

ARTICLE 345

State Legislature may adopt one or more languages in use in the State, or Hindi.
English continues until State law otherwise provides within the constitutional frame.

ARTICLE 346

Union-State and inter-State communication follows the authorised Union language,
subject to agreement permitting Hindi between States.

ARTICLE 347

President may recognise a language for specified State purposes on substantial-demand grounds.

TRAPS

Eighth-Schedule inclusion is not a prerequisite for State official-language choice.
Article 347 is not automatic recognition or a general national-language declaration.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 5/12: Articles 348-349: courts, judgments and authoritative texts

ARTICLE 348 BASELINE

English for Supreme Court and High Court proceedings until Parliament provides otherwise.
English authoritative texts for Bills, Acts, ordinances, orders, rules and bye-laws.

HIGH COURT PROCEEDINGS

Governor + previous presidential consent -> Hindi or State official language.
Article 348(2) expressly excludes judgments, decrees and orders.

SECTION 7 ROUTE

authorised non-English High Court judgment/decreed/order in addition to English
-> High Court-authorised English translation.

ARTICLE 349

historically time-bounded special procedure; not a routine present-day gate.

LIMIT

machine or general-information translation is not automatically authoritative law.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 6/12: Authoritative-text hierarchy across Constitution and statutes

ENGLISH BASELINE

Article 348(1): court proceedings and authoritative legislative/delegated texts.

HINDI ROUTES

1963 Act section 5: authorised Hindi Central texts.

section 6: authorised Hindi State text in specified cases.

OTHER SCHEDULED LANGUAGES

Authoritative Texts (Central Laws) Act 1973:

Presidential authority + Official Gazette -> authoritative Central-law translation.

HIGH COURT JUDGMENTS

section 7: authorised non-English judgment + High Court-authorised English translation.

TRAP

translation utility, including machine output, does not itself confer authority.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 7/12: Articles 350, 350A, 350B and 351: access and development

ARTICLE 350

representation for grievance redress may use a language used in the Union or State.

ARTICLE 350A

endeavour to provide mother-tongue instruction facilities at primary stage
for children belonging to linguistic-minority groups.

ARTICLE 350B

Special Officer investigates safeguards -> reports to President
-> laid before Parliament and sent to concerned State governments.

ARTICLE 351

Union duty to promote Hindi and develop it as a medium for India's composite culture,
drawing vocabulary principally from Sanskrit and secondarily from other languages.

BALANCE

promotion of Hindi operates with, not above, plural safeguards and federal consent.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 8/12: 1976 Rules: administrative routing

RULES 1976

official portal shows amendments in 1987, 2007 and 2011; extent excludes Tamil Nadu.

FIRST QUESTION

Central office to non-Central recipient -> Rule 3 and Region A/B/C.

Central office to Central office -> Rule 4.

DOCUMENT CONTROLS

reply to Hindi -> Hindi | section 3(3) documents -> Hindi + English.

applications/file notes -> employee safeguards under Rules 7-8.

CURRENT CAUTION

A/B/C are administrative communication categories, not constitutional rankings.

Do not silently modernise territorial names beyond the authoritative rule text.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 9/12: Eighth Schedule and separate policy categories

EIGHTH SCHEDULE

22 languages in the current official Constitution.

14 original -> Sindhi -> Konkani/Manipuri/Nepali -> Bodo/Dogri/Maithili/Santhal
-> Oriya renamed Odia.

EFFECT

constitutional recognition and Article 344/351 relevance.

No automatic Union, State, court or school-medium status follows.

CLASSICAL STATUS

separate Union executive recognition.

October 2024 additions brought the official count then reported to eleven.

THREE-LANGUAGE FORMULA

education-policy framework with State implementation variation.

It is not a constitutional national-language command.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 10/12: Language cases: competence, minority context and protected choice

Regional University v. Shri Krishna (1963)

medium/language power must respect the Union-State education competence boundary.

D.A.V. College v. State of Punjab (1971)

linguistic-minority safeguards require contextual constitutional analysis.

State of Karnataka v. Associated Management (2014)

compulsory mother-tongue medium cannot override protected educational choice.

DOCTRINAL TRIANGLE

legislative competence | speech/choice rights | linguistic-minority safeguards.

LIMIT

none of these decisions declares a national language or erases Article 350A.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 11/12: Federal accommodation, court access and translation technology

LEGITIMATE GOALS

administrative interoperability | citizen access | cultural recognition
| judicial usability | educational inclusion.

RISKS

imposition | exclusion from employment/services | translation error
| authoritative-text confusion | weak minority facilities | digital language divide.

TECHNOLOGY CHAIN

multilingual intake -> translation/interpretation -> human legal review
-> authority label -> version control -> accessible publication.

FEDERAL METHOD

consent + capacity + phased implementation + reciprocal communication.

LIMIT

policy targets, committee recommendations and software outputs do not amend Part XVII.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 12/12: UPSC traps, verified PYQ and qualified answer synthesis

PRELIMS FIREWALL

official != national | 22 scheduled languages | Hindi script = Devanagari
| numerals = international form | English continuation = statute
| Article 348(2) excludes judgments | section 7 supplies separate route
| Article 350 grievance right | 350A instruction facility | 350B Special Officer
| classical and three-language categories are separate.

2024 PRELIMS ROUTE

21st, 71st and 92nd Amendment language additions.

MAINS SPINE

constitutional compromise -> Part XVII -> 1963 Act
-> State autonomy -> court/text hierarchy -> minority safeguards
-> category distinctions -> access technology -> federal verdict.

CONCLUSION

multilingual unity requires exact law, consent and authoritative parity.